

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter in association with **The Daily Ceilidh**

COMMUNITY HATCHERY SURVEY

Welcome to issue 27 of the Bernera News.

We were delighted to watch the bonfire being lit and the fireworks casting their colours across the sky, heralding that winter is approaching with all its promise of cosy fires and a season of family and friends gathering.

Gathering is a delight after the last couple of years of the pandemic, and the hall welcomed us all afterwards with tasty food and hot drinks.

Of course winter brings wind, frost and rain too, but nevertheless we're glad of the warmth of community as our busy summer season draws to a close and life becomes less busy.

Everyone has been extra supportive of Nat particularly during the last 13 weeks, whilst he has been unwell and limited in his usual tasks around the Croft, and including producing the Bernera News (hence it's absence!).

We would like to thank you all for your kindnesses, messages and help. He's finally getting back to his normal self.

Thanks again to all our contributors for making this publication possible!

The GBCDT plans for the Hatchery are moving ahead! Building on consultation in 2021, we plan to develop the building as a community-owned, social enterprise hub with space and equipment for businesses, entrepreneurs and the community.

We now are working with Community Enterprise to determine who will use these facilities and how, whether it will be financially sustainable and contribute to our overall aims as a community, and to develop a business plan to make our case to funders.

Please share your ideas for this space at surveymonkey.co.uk/r/GBCDTHatchery

We'll be working alongside Bernera Community Association and the Community Council in November to advance plans for this and other projects - more details coming soon.

GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2022



GREAT BERNERA
- Community Development Trust -

The AGM of the Great Bernera Community Development Trust will be held on **Monday 14th November 2022**

at 7.30pm. The meeting will be held at the Bernera Community Hall.

All Bernera residents are welcome to attend the meeting, and non-members are welcome to join the Trust for a contribution of £1.

Any Bernera resident who wishes to stand as a Trustee/Director of the Trust may do so, and should request a nomination form by emailing nat@greatbernera.org

FOOD BANK FILING CABINET

Please come and help yourself to our food and toiletries selection.

Available inside the filing cabinet by the front door of **7 James Street, Stornoway.**

HEBRIDES MOUNTAIN RESCUE TEAM

Heb MRT are looking for people with a passion for the outdoors, who are up for learning new skills to help save lives in challenging situations. If you're interested in joining the team get in touch at contact@hebmrt.org or visit their website at www.hebmrt.org

BALANCE

As we age most of us will notice a decline in our physical abilities. We might not be quite so supple as we were when we were younger, or we might tire more easily. Perhaps one thing that is often overlooked is our ability to balance.

Earlier this year, the British Journal for Sports Medicine published the results of a decade-long study. This study, involving more than 1,700 middle-aged participants, concluded that an inability to balance was associated with an almost twofold increase in risk of death. This shocking result, which took into account the age, sex, and other underlying health conditions, brought further credibility to a number of other studies, carried out over the years, which have made similar connections between the ability to rise from the floor to a standing position, balance with one eye closed, or simply to walk at a brisk pace, and longevity. Of course, in some cases poor balance is a byproduct of more serious existing conditions, but the studies all suggest that by maintaining good balance some other problems might be kept at bay.

Our bodies seem to develop an innate sense of balance as children, and from then on we more often than not don't think more about it until it starts to fail us. Perhaps we struggle to stand on one foot in order to put a shoe on and simply put it down to ageing. However, balance appears to be one thing that we can affect, and the key is to address the decline before it gets serious, and that can happen earlier than you think.

Of course, one of the key factors is our general activity. The more active we are, and the more active we stay, the better our balance tends to stay. However, we still need to be taking part in activities that challenge our balance, for example walking or running on rough ground, alongside more challenging activities such as skating, or stand up paddleboarding, before the decline starts. Of course, as we get older, or if we are already struggling with reduced balance, more gentle activities that have a focus on balance can really help, these include Tai chi or Yoga, or perhaps just simple balance exercises we can do at home, such as standing on one leg (make sure to hold on to something for support if needed). Just 15 minutes a day of balance practice can be beneficial.

YOGA CLASSES



Fancy getting a bit more stretch in your life and would like to do Yoga?
Ekki Mukk Spirited Yoga is running weekly Wednesday evening sessions and will be offering early Saturday morning sessions soon.

Join Victoria on Wednesdays at 6:30pm (1 hour class)
 Bernera Community Centre Hall
 £5 per session (Beginners welcome)
 Call **07912 292 816** / or email victoria.evans05@hotmail.co.uk

ANGUS MACIVER WATCH PRESENTATION



On Monday 24th of October 2022 a special presentation took place on Bernera.

A pocket watch presented by the people of Bernera in July 1953 in appreciation of his untiring efforts in the cause of the Bernera Bridge to Angus Maciver was returned to the people of Bernera by his grandson also called Angus Maciver.

Angus (1895-1965) was a son of Finlay Maciver and Peggy Macinnes from 7 Breacleite. During the First World War Angus was interned in the Netherlands at HMS Timbertown and was awarded the Mons Star. After the war he became a school teacher, teaching

in Scarp and then Leverburgh where he stayed as headmaster until his retirement in 1960. Angus married Peggy Ann Macleod from 11 Breacleite; the couple lived in Leverburgh until Angus's retirement when they moved to Laxdale.

Angus was most proactive in lobbying for the Bernera Bridge to be built even though he no longer lived on Bernera himself and bombarded Ross and Cromarty council, the local MP and Stornoway Gazette with letters demanding that the bridge be built for the benefit of all on Bernera. He actually 'borrowed' the name of a Bernera resident for these letters as he felt that they would have more weight coming from a Bernera resident rather than a Bernera man living in Leverburgh. He is said to have suggested in one of his letters that there was a supply of dynamite on Bernera and that the locals were planning on blasting the cliff to build a causeway across where the bridge is now. There is no proof of this claim but it was taken seriously as something Bernera folk were liable to do and as this would have seriously impacted on the salmon run in Loch Barraglom, may have been the final catalyst for the bridge to be built.

This pocket watch was one of two presented by the people of Bernera at the opening of the bridge, the other was given to the chief engineer Bill Eadie. Angus Maciver, now from Windsor, contacted Bernera Comunn Eachdraidh in June this year with an offer to donate the watch to Bernera Museum where it could be displayed for all to once again see in Bernera. Along with his wife and step mother Angus came to Bernera Museum and Bernera Bridge to make the presentation to the trustees of the museum and to invited relatives still living on Bernera and Lewis.

The watch will be on display in the museum when it reopens in May 2023.

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



CONNECT FOUR QUIZ - ANSWERS

What word or thing connects these words

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Punch | 12.Length | 23.Castle |
| 2. Party | 13.Plays | 24.Tie Knots |
| 3. Rubber | 14.Blown | 25.Car Models |
| 4. Guards | 15.Fruit | 26.RN Vessels |
| 5. River | 16.Shipping Areas | 27.Tray |
| 6. Sea | 17.Ancient Gods | 28.Coffee Beans |
| 7. Booth | 18.Sci-fi TV Series | 29.Ball |
| 8. Shoes | 19.Pottery | 30.Fair |
| 9. Cross | 20.Noble Gasses | |
| 10.Polish | 21.Scottish Coalmines | |
| 11.Jeans | 22.Scottish Inventors | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



AN T-SÌDE



Fhad 's a bha mi nam sheasamh aig an uinneig a' coimhead ris na duilleagan a' sèideadh anns a' ghaoith, thàinig na mìosan a chaidh seachad nam inntinn : Làithean le teas anabarrach air feadh na dùthcha agus, uime sin, dìth bùirn. Cùin a chunnacas sin a-riamh! Gu fortanach, an seo anns na h- Eileanan cha robh aobhar a bhith a' gearain mun teas idir idir. An àite sin, bha an t- uisge ann gu tric. Is truagh nach b'urrainn dhuinn cuid dheth a roinn. Deagh shìde neo droch shìde? 'S e cuspair cudromach a th' ann am measg nam Breatannach, mar sin leanaidh mi orm a' sgrìobhadh rudeigin eile mun t-side.

Ann am Pearù faodaidh sibh na siantan gu lèir fhaighinn, ach tha sin an crochadh air an sgìre anns a bheil tha sibh a' fuireach.

'S e dùthaich thropaigeach a th' ann le measgachadh de cliomaidean.

Tha trì pàirtean eadar - dhealaichte ann!

Am fàsach tioram air oirthir a' Chuain Shèimh san taobh an iar.

Na beanntan garbha, na h-Andes, ann am meadhan na dùthcha far a bheil e nas fhuair le gaoth is uisge trom, gu h-àraidh as t-samradh. Tha na sgorran an còmhnaidh comhdaichte le sneachda agus uairean-nan, bidh e a' cur air na slèibhtean. Nuair a thachras seo, bidh an t- arm a' cuideachadh le heileacoptaire-an gu biadh a thilgeil sìos do na h-alpacas agus beathaichean eile.

Agus mu dheireadh am pàirt as motha, an dlùth - choille chun an ear. An seo tha an t-uisge ann fad na bliadhna agus tha e bruthainneach is tais is glè thèth, mar as trice timcheall air 35C.

Bha mise a' fuireach ann am baile mòr air an oirthir, ach ged a tha e anns an fhàsach, chan eil e ro theth an sin. Tha an t-side gu math tlachdmhor, a' toirt am fàr - ainm don bhaile: "Baile an Earraich Shìorraidh." Gu cumanta, cha robh ach fras neo dhà ann fad na bliadhna. Bha sin a' ciallachadh nach biodh bùrn againn gu math tric airson làithean. An uair sin bhiodh làraidhean a' draibheadh tron bhaile, a' com - phàirteachadh bùirn gu na taighean.

Aon bhliadhna ge-tà bha a h-uile rud eadar - dhealaichte. Bha mi air cluinntinn mun nì neo - àbhaisteach: "El Nino", ach cha do dh' fhairich sinn fhèin e gus an Gearran, 1998.

Bha uisge nan seachd sìan ann gun stad airson seachdainn. Thoisich na mullaichean uile a' call agus bha puill anns a h-uile àite.

An uair sin bhris balla - bacadh faisg air a' bhaile, a' tuileachadh seann chladh is a' tionndadh na sràidean gu aibhnichean. Bha sin dìreach uabhasach oir thug iad leotha cisteachan agus criàmhan suas dhan phrìomh - cheàrnag!

Mu dheireadh thall bha turadh ann a-rithist. Abair faothachadh!

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



CROFT 22



Forage, our little honesty shop in Kirkibost, has celebrated it's first anniversary recently. Judging by the number of lovely messages we've received, it has helped shoppers to fill the gaps in their requirements, inbetween town trips. We continue to work to ensure that the prices are as low as possible and just cover the costs of running the service.

In anticipation of a busy Christmas period, we are delighted to announce that we are doing Scottish Christmas cheese and Hebridean nibble baskets, Italian treats and Eco friendly gifts from the 25th November.

So pop down and pay us a visit or drop us a line at julia@croft22.co.uk.



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

PLEASE JOIN US AT OUR AGM on the 14th NOVEMBER 2022

As we share and discuss with you the Crofting Community Right to Buy, Part 3 and your part in it in this process.

AGM and how you can help us moving forward:

On November 14th the Trust are holding their annual AGM and are encouraging as many residents as possible to attend this event. Gathered information and voting procedure for the part 3 application will be shared at the AGM, and the way forward discussed. It is an important part of the Buy Out for us all and we hope, a turning point.

At the AGM we will also be looking for new Members and looking to appoint new Directors to help take this process forward.

If you have an interest in helping us move forward with the Buy Out process, now or in the future, please email jo@greatbernera.org or nat@greatbernera.org. All help is welcomed.

Buy Out Update:

Some of you may be wondering what has been happening with the Buy Out of late. As many of you may be aware, Bernera's ongoing negotiations with the Landlord to buy the Estate had reached a stalemate situation. In recent months the difficulties have been highlighted in the media and were brought to the attention of the Scottish Parliament through a chamber debate in June, led by MSP Alasdair Allan. It was encouraging to see the issue receive cross party support across the chamber.

While the current Part 2 Buy Out process has come to a standstill, with little option, the Trust have turned their attention to a Part 3 application 'forcing a sale under a Part 3 'Crofting Community Right to Buy' of the Land Reform Act. Taking this route is not a straightforward process and includes many new legal and procedural steps, including a crucial vote which must be taken before the Trust can submit the application. At present the Trust, with help from Mr Allan, CnES and the Scottish Government are working their way through these steps and preparing for the Part 3 vote.

Cost of living crisis support:

We are delighted to announce that the Trust have secured funding over two years to provide a new service for residents in our community to support them through the cost-of-living crisis. We will be working in conjunction with Bernera Community Association, local charities, organizations, and volunteers to provide practical help and support, advice, and signposting sessions. We'll be posting more information on Facebook and in the Bernera News, in late November.

MANY THANKS TO ALL



Ben and Annette want to express their sincere thanks and appreciation shown by so many on the occasion of their recent 50th wedding anniversary. Bernera is certainly not the place to keep secrets: but our secret got out, and so many kindnesses followed.

Thank you also to all who were involved in the lovely Saturday afternoon tea in the Hall.

Therefore, very many thanks.

Ben and Annette.

TIME

I recently came across the following poem by an unknown poet:

When as a child I laughed and wept, time crept. When as a youth I dreamed and talked, time walked. When I became a full grown man, time ran. And later as I older grew, time flew. Soon I shall find while traveling on, time gone.

The writer reminds us of the transience of time and the limited opportunities we have to contribute to this big world we inhabit and enjoy. Catching, a bus, meeting a friend, arranging an appointment all require our attention, diligence and prioritisation. Sometimes, we need to substitute one thing for another to allow us to overtake that task, meeting, event that we consider to be the most important.

And the Bible speaks about a lady who prioritised her soul's wellbeing over and above everything else. Her name was Martha. A woman, whose choice, Jesus applauded; *"But one thing is needed, and Mary has chosen that good part, which will not be taken away from her."* **Luke 10:42**

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



BERNERA BAKES... FRUIT LOAF

This is my mam's recipe. You can eat it alone, with butter, fried with bacon and egg or custard. X

Ingredients:

- 8oz** sultanas
- 1** teacup water
- 4oz** margarine
- 1** teacup caster sugar
- 2** teaspoons mixed spice
- 1** teaspoon Bicarbonate of soda
- pinch salt
- 2** teacups S.R. flour
- 2** eggs



Method:

1. Grease and line a 2lb loaf tin.
2. Preheat oven at 170°C.
3. Simmer sultanas, water, salt, margarine, caster sugar, mixed spice and baking soda in a pan for 5mins.
4. Allow to cool.
5. When cool add flour & beaten eggs mixing well.
6. Place into a 2lb loaf tin & bake for 1½ hours.

Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



HAVE YOU SEEN TARQUIN?



You may know him as the black cat that holds up traffic in Earshader. He was last seen wearing the grey tick collar you see in the photo, in front of 1B Earshader about a month ago. If you have taken him in or found him in an outside building, could you please let me know. It's unusual for him not to come home each day.

Virginia 07460467721